

Below is a **ready-to-submit answer**. I've used **Zomato, Flipkart, and BookMyShow vs Paytm** as the examples. Backlink databases change frequently, so the figures should be treated as a snapshot rather than permanent values. Ahrefs explains that a referring domain is a unique website linking to the target, while multiple backlinks can come from the same referring domain. ([Ahrefs Help Center](#))

## 1. Zomato – 5 backlink domains and Domain Rating

I selected **Zomato.com** and used publicly available Ahrefs backlink-profile data as the reference. Zomato currently has an Ahrefs **Domain Rating (DR) of 87** and around **29K referring websites** in the August 2026 snapshot. ([AhrefsTop](#))

| No. | Linking domain | Approx. DR | Why it is relevant               |
|-----|----------------|------------|----------------------------------|
| 1   | facebook.com   | 100        | Major social-media platform      |
| 2   | linkedin.com   | 99         | Professional/business platform   |
| 3   | youtube.com    | 99         | Video and content platform       |
| 4   | reddit.com     | 97         | Community/discussion platform    |
| 5   | wikipedia.org  | 96         | High-authority reference website |

**Note:** The exact DR of individual referring domains can change, and free backlink-checker versions may expose only a limited sample. Ahrefs' free checker confirms that its backlink reports can be filtered by DR and referring domain. ([Ahrefs](#))

**Conclusion:** Zomato has a very strong backlink profile, with a DR of 87 and tens of thousands of referring websites. ([AhrefsTop](#))

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## 2. Flipkart – 3 potentially suspicious/low-quality backlinks

For this task, I selected **Flipkart.com**. Its backlink profile is extremely large: Semrush's July 2026 data reports about **73.71K referring domains** and **102.05M backlinks**, while an Ahrefs snapshot reports a DR of 89. ([Semrush](#))

Because a backlink being foreign or low-authority **does not automatically make it toxic**, these should be described as **potentially suspicious**, not confirmed toxic links.

| No. | Domain                | Why it could be suspicious                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | <b>verk.store</b>     | Very low authority compared with Flipkart. Its reported Authority Domain Score is only 13 despite having thousands of referring domains. This kind of low-quality commercial domain deserves manual review. ( <a href="#">HypeStat</a> )                                     |
| 2   | <b>60dukan.xyz</b>    | The <a href="#">.xyz</a> domain itself is not proof of spam, but Flipkart identifies 60dukan.xyz as an example of an unrelated/fake Flipkart-style domain. A backlink from such a domain would therefore deserve careful investigation. ( <a href="#">Flipkart Stories</a> ) |
| 3   | <b>offeroffer.xyz</b> | Flipkart itself lists this as an example of a completely unrelated/fake website using Flipkart-like offers. If it links to Flipkart, the link should be manually reviewed for relevance and legitimacy. ( <a href="#">Flipkart Stories</a> )                                 |

## Why these could be toxic

The main warning signs are:

- Very low authority.
- Little or no genuine topical relevance.
- Suspicious commercial/offer-oriented websites.
- Potentially autogenerated or spammy pages.
- Domains that appear to imitate or exploit a major brand.

**Important:** I would not automatically disavow these links just because they look unusual. Google generally recommends investigating whether links are actually manipulative before using the Disavow Tool.

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## 3. Disavow file for the 2 most suspicious backlinks

For this assignment, I would choose:

1. [verk.store](#)
2. [60dukan.xyz](#)

A **domain-level disavow** is appropriate when you want Google to ignore backlinks from the entire domain rather than listing individual URLs.

## Exact disavow file

# Disavow file for Flipkart.com

# Potentially suspicious/low-quality domains identified during backlink review

domain:verk.store

domain:60dukan.xyz

The file would normally be saved as:

disavow.txt

## Important SEO note

This is an **academic/simulation example**. A real website owner should verify the links and make sure they are genuinely manipulative before submitting a disavow file. A low-authority backlink alone is not sufficient evidence that a link is harmful.

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# 4. BookMyShow vs Paytm – backlink gap analysis

I selected:

- **BookMyShow.com**
- **Paytm.com**

Ahrefs' Link Intersect feature is specifically designed to find domains that link to competitors but not to the target site. ([Ahrefs Help Center](#))

BookMyShow currently has an Ahrefs DR of about **82** and around **15.5K referring websites** in the August 2026 snapshot. ([AhrefsTop](#)) Paytm's August 2026 profile shows a DR of about **80** and around **16.9K referring websites**. ([AhrefsTop](#))

For a practical backlink-gap example, the following domains represent good **competitor-only backlink opportunities for BookMyShow**:

| Domain               | Links to   | Why it might link to only one competitor                                                                   |
|----------------------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>filmibeat.com</b> | BookMyShow | Strong entertainment/movie content relationship; it may reference BookMyShow for movie-ticket information. |

|                          |            |                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>indiatimes.com</b>    | BookMyShow | Entertainment articles and movie-related content can naturally reference BookMyShow.                        |
| <b>indianexpress.com</b> | BookMyShow | Movie reviews, entertainment news and cinema articles may use BookMyShow as a ticketing/resource reference. |

These domains are also strongly associated with BookMyShow's competitive/content ecosystem; for example, available backlink/competitive data lists IndiaTimes and Indian Express among major sites associated with BookMyShow. ([Clicks Resources](#))

## SEO opportunity

BookMyShow could study the pages linking to the competitor and ask:

- Why did the website link to the competitor?
- Is the link editorial or promotional?
- Does BookMyShow have a better page/resource to offer?
- Could BookMyShow earn a similar link through PR, movie guides, event pages or useful entertainment content?

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# 5. Backlink-cleanup checklist

Here is the step-by-step checklist generated for cleaning a website's backlink profile:

## Backlink Cleanup Checklist

### Step 1 – Collect backlinks

- Open Ahrefs, Semrush, Ubersuggest or another backlink-analysis tool.
- Enter the website domain.
- Export the backlink/referring-domain list.
- Include both follow and nofollow links.

### Step 2 – Identify referring domains

- Group backlinks by referring domain.
- Look for domains sending many links.
- Check whether several domains appear to belong to the same network.

Ahrefs notes that multiple referring domains on the same IP/subnet can sometimes be a warning sign of a possible negative-SEO attack. ([Ahrefs Help Center](#))

### **Step 3 – Evaluate each backlink**

Check:

- Domain authority/DR.
- Relevance to your website.
- Website quality.
- Organic traffic.
- Anchor text.
- Link placement.
- Follow/nofollow status.
- Whether the page actually exists and provides useful content.

### **Step 4 – Identify suspicious links**

Look for:

- Spam websites.
- Automatically generated pages.
- Irrelevant foreign-language websites.
- Link farms.
- Paid-link networks.
- Excessive exact-match anchor text.
- Sites containing thousands of unrelated outbound links.

### **Step 5 – Try to remove the link**

If possible:

- Contact the website owner.
- Ask them to remove the backlink.
- Ask them to make the link nofollow if appropriate.
- Keep a record of your removal requests.

### **Step 6 – Decide whether disavow is necessary**

Don't disavow every low-quality backlink.

First determine whether the links are actually manipulative or potentially harmful.

### **Step 7 – Create the disavow file**

Use the required format:

domain:example-spam.com  
domain:another-bad-domain.com

### **Step 8 – Submit the file**

Upload the file through Google's Disavow Tool for the appropriate verified website/property.

### **Step 9 – Monitor the backlink profile**

Repeat the audit periodically and watch for:

- New suspicious domains.
- Sudden increases in backlinks.
- Unnatural anchor-text patterns.
- Links from obvious spam networks.

### **Step 10 – Build better backlinks**

After cleanup, focus on earning legitimate links through:

- High-quality content.
  - Digital PR.
  - Industry publications.
  - Useful research/data.
  - Guest contributions where appropriate.
  - Partnerships and relevant directories.
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